CHAPTER V.

MEDICAL ELECTRICITY.

ELECTRICITY is one of a great variety of forces, all of which are probably of identical essence, viz., motion, and are therefore now popularly known as "modes of motion."

Whether electricity is, as many scientists claim, the element in which resides the sum of all forces and motors, it is a settled fact that natural electricity is present in all bodies. Whatever the ultimate combination of forces may be which produces in animate beings the result so vaguely called "life principle," the author claims that there are in the human system a sufficient number of phenomena accompanying nervous and muscular and nervous and arterial action to demonstrate that the said "life principle" is something analogous to electricity, and that this force, properly distributed throughout the organism, maintains health, and when disturbed results in disease, and when suspended, is death.

As electric forces of the human organism are simply modifications of those which vitalize nature at large, it follows that any excess or diminution in their quantity, or any impoverishment of their quality, must result in a disordered condition of the organism.

Vital forces, in health and disease, are but modes